

Friday, 4 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Light drizzle 21° 17°	BIRMINGHAM Rain 19° 15°	MANCHESTER Rain 18° 15°	GLASGOW Light rain 16° 13°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The leaders of the UK and France, Andy Burnham and Emmanuel Macron, have agreed to step up joint action on tackling small boats.

Number 10 says they also discussed the ongoing situation in Ukraine and the UK's desire for closer ties with Europe. This comes as a BBC investigation reveals channel smuggling gangs are now using 'mega-dinghies' due to a shortage of smaller boats.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

Households across the UK are being warned that a potential gas price spike could mean higher energy bills.

Experts are concerned that low storage levels could push up gas prices even further. This could leave many families facing increased costs as we head into colder months.

ENERGY · UK
- 3

A pupil who stabbed a teacher in the head during a classroom attack has been given a four-year detention order.

Vicki Williams, the teacher involved, bravely spoke about fearing for her life during the incident at Milford Haven Comprehensive School. The court heard the harrowing details of the attack.

CRIME · UK
- 4

Channel smuggling gangs are reportedly resorting to using 'mega-dinghies' as a crackdown limits the supply of smaller boats.

A BBC investigation found that once-rival criminal groups are now being forced to work together. This shift highlights the impact of increased efforts to disrupt illegal crossings.

MIGRATION · UK
- 5

Helicopters are to be put on standby across the UK when the risk of wildfires is particularly high.

The Justice Secretary confirmed that aerial water bombing was crucial in tackling a large fire in the Cairngorms recently. This new measure aims to improve rapid response to future outbreaks.

ENVIRONMENT · UK

What's coming up

1 **Get ready for more fabulousness as a new wave of queens compete for the crown in the eighth series of Drag Race UK!**

These contestants grew up watching the hit reality show and are now ready to snatch the top prize. It's going to be an exciting season with plenty of drama and dazzling looks.

ON AIR – Who do you think will be the standout queen this year?

TV · COMING UP

2 **Fans are full of praise for Catherine Zeta-Jones after she used her natural Welsh accent in a new thriller series.**

The Hollywood actress, originally from Swansea, is starring in the new drama. Viewers are delighted to hear her authentic voice on screen.

ON AIR – Isn't it great when stars embrace their roots in their roles?

TV · NEW RELEASE

3 **Celebrity Traitors winner Alan Carr has lodged plans to turn a potting shed at his castle into a new café.**

Alan bought the 19th-century Ayton Castle earlier this year and is transforming it into a home for his TV programme. It sounds like a charming new venture!

ON AIR – If you could turn any outbuilding into something new, what would it be?

TV · FUTURE PLANS

4 **The King has hailed an 'unprecedented' exhibition of the historic Bayeux Tapestry opening in London.**

British and French leaders will be at the British Museum to see the incredible artwork. The 70-metre tapestry tells the story of the Norman Conquest and the Battle of Hastings.

ON AIR – Have you ever seen the Bayeux Tapestry? It's truly a piece of history!

EXHIBITION · COMING UP

5 **Sadie Sink and Adam Driver are set to star in a brand new X-Men movie, joining the Marvel Cinematic Universe.**

They'll be joined by Heartstopper's Kit Connor and Christopher Abbot. It's exciting news for fans of the superhero franchise!

ON AIR – Which X-Men character do you think Sadie Sink or Adam Driver would be perfect for?

FILM · CASTING

On the schedule

1 Arsenal winger Gabriel Martinelli has made a big move to Saudi Pro League side Al-Hilal in a deal worth a reported £60 million.

This is another significant transfer in what has been a busy summer for Saudi clubs. Martinelli's departure will certainly be felt by Arsenal fans.

ON AIR – What do you make of so many top players heading to the Saudi League?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 Chelsea have had a staggering 39 player exits this summer, reportedly recouping over £500 million from sales and loans.

The club has seen a massive clear-out and restructuring of their squad. It's an incredible number of players to move on in one transfer window.

ON AIR – Do you think this huge clear-out will ultimately benefit Chelsea?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 England's Issy Wong took her first-ever five-wicket haul in One Day International cricket during the second ODI in Derby.

It was an excellent performance from the bowler, helping England to a strong position. She'll be hoping to continue this form throughout the series.

ON AIR – How important is it to see young talent like Issy Wong excelling in international cricket?

CRICKET · UK

4 The Italian Grand Prix has been declared a 'heat-hazard' race due to the continuing high temperatures in the country.

Following a summer heatwave, conditions are still extremely warm for the drivers and teams. It will certainly add an extra challenge to the race weekend.

ON AIR – How much do extreme weather conditions impact the F1 drivers and their performance?

FORMULA 1 · INTERNATIONAL

5 St Helens centre and former England international Mark Percival has announced he will retire from rugby league at the end of the season.

Percival has been a key player for St Helens and his country throughout his career. He'll be looking to finish on a high note.

ON AIR – What's your favourite memory of watching Mark Percival play?

RUGBY LEAGUE · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees people embracing 'mindful walking' as a way to connect with nature and de-stress.**
Instead of rushing, participants focus on their surroundings, observing details like leaves rustling or birdsong, turning a simple stroll into a peaceful meditation.
- 2 The joy of 'retro board games' is making a grand comeback in living rooms across the nation.**
Families and friends are rediscovering the fun of classic games like 'Ludo' and 'Snakes and Ladders', offering a screen-free way to spend quality time together.
- 3 Local communities are finding creative ways to 'decorate public spaces' with vibrant, uplifting art.**
From painted benches to colourful murals, these projects are transforming overlooked corners into delightful spots, bringing a little extra cheer to daily life.
- 4 A surge in popularity for 'homemade bread making' continues to rise across the UK.**
More individuals are enjoying the satisfying process of kneading dough and the comforting aroma of freshly baked loaves, often sharing their creations with neighbours.
- 5 The simple pleasure of 'writing and sending postcards' is experiencing a charming revival.**
Many are choosing to send heartfelt messages and holiday greetings on traditional postcards, cherishing the personal touch in an increasingly digital world.
- 6 Botanical art, the intricate painting of plants and flowers, is gaining new enthusiasts.**
This calming hobby allows people to appreciate the delicate beauty of flora up close, creating stunning and detailed works of art.
- 7 The trend of 'repurposing vintage textiles' into new fashion items is capturing the imagination of designers and hobbyists.**
Old scarves, tablecloths, and even curtains are being transformed into unique garments and accessories, promoting sustainable fashion.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of ice cream will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: GENTLY SQUEEZING THE TUB TO FEEL ITS DENSITY, HOPING IT INDICATES CREAMINESS.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, warm bath, especially if it's a new bubble bath. What is it?

ANSWER: RUNNING A TINY BIT UNDER THE TAP, JUST TO SNIFF THE BUBBLES FOR THE FIRST SCENT.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you spot a 'really unusual or charming garden ornament' in someone's front garden, and it just makes you smile?**

What's the most quirky or delightful garden decoration you've ever seen, either in your own garden or somewhere you've passed by? Perhaps a miniature gnome village, or a brightly painted birdhouse?

- **We all have those 'little rituals' we do on a Friday evening, don't we, that signal the start of the weekend?**

What's your go-to Friday evening ritual that always helps you switch off and look forward to the weekend? Is it a particular takeaway, a specific film, or just putting on your comfiest slippers?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Octopuses have three hearts: two pump blood through the gills, and one circulates it to the rest of the body.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies taste with their antennae, which is how they locate the sweetest nectar.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£6.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£6.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's smallest commercially produced car was the Peel P50, a three-wheeled microcar.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have even found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.
- The 'smiley face' emoji was invented in 1982 by Scott Fahlman.
- The average person walks the equivalent of three times around the world in their lifetime.
- Carrots were originally purple before they were selectively bred to be orange.
- The Queen of England owned all the unmarked swans in open waters across the country.

On this day

Day 247 of the year, 118 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Candida the Elder; Christian feast day: Blessed Catherine of Racconigi; Christian feast day: Blessed Dina Bélanger; Christian feast day: Hermione of Ephesus. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1993 — Emma Brownlie, Scottish footballer
- 1978 — Wes Bentley, American actor and producer
- 1961 — Nick Binko, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1994 — Thomas Minns, English rugby player
- 1968 — John DiMaggio, American voice actor
- 1945 — Danny Gatton, American guitarist (died 1994)
- 1946 — Gary Duncan, American guitarist (died 2019)
- 1996 — Jordan Lilley, English rugby league player

THE DAY TODAY

- 1964 — Scotland's Forth Road Bridge near Edinburgh officially opens.
- 2020 — Pope Benedict XVI becomes the longest-lived pope, 93 years, four months, 16 days, surpassing Pope Leo XIII, who died in 1903.
- 1950 — Darlington Raceway is the site of the inaugural Southern 500, the first 500-mile NASCAR race.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2002 — The Oakland Athletics win their 20th consecutive game, an American League record, until the Cleveland Indians surpassed it in 2017.
- 1970 — Salvador Allende is elected President of Chile.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1941 — World War II: A German submarine makes the first attack of the war against a United States warship, the USS Greer.
- 1971 — Alaska Airlines Flight 1866 crashes near Juneau, Alaska, killing all 111 people on board.

- 1950 — Darlington Raceway is the site of the inaugural Southern 500, the first 500-mile NASCAR race.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 248 of the year, 117 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Bertin; Christian feast day: Charbel (martyr); Christian feast day: Genebald; Christian feast day: Gregorio Aglipay (Episcopal Church). Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1974 — Lauren Jeska, British fell runner convicted of the attempted murder of Ralph Knibbs
- 1970 — Johnny Vegas, English actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1946 — Freddie Mercury, British singer and songwriter (died 1991)
- 1946 — Dean Ford, Scottish singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2018)
- 1947 — Buddy Miles, American singer-songwriter and drummer (died 2008)
- 1945 — Al Stewart, Scottish singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1984 — Annabelle Wallis, English actress
- 1969 — Dweezil Zappa, American actor and musician

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1986 — Pan Am Flight 73 from Mumbai, India with 358 people on board is hijacked at Karachi International Airport.
- 2012 — An accidental explosion at a Turkish Army ammunition store in Afyon, western Turkey kills 25 soldiers and wounds four others.
- 1990 — Sri Lankan Civil War: Sri Lankan Army soldiers slaughter 158 civilians.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1986 — Pan Am Flight 73 from Mumbai, India with 358 people on board is hijacked at Karachi International Airport.
- 1977 — Voyager Program: NASA launches the Voyager 1 spacecraft.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING • FILM

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
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FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
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FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
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FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
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OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
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FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)
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11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar